

YEAR 1 | SEMESTER 1

SSMS MANUAL



Y1 SEMESTER 1 MANUAL

Safety and Security Management Studies - SSMS

The Hague University of Applied Science

2026/2027

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THE HAGUE
UNIVERSITY OF
APPLIED SCIENCES

Colophon

Y1 SEMESTER 1 MANUAL

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Natasza Respondek

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1. MODULE DESCRIPTION

1.1. Module structure

Semester 1	Semester 2
Intro to Safety & Security	Business & Quality Management
Governance & Policy	Law & Compliance
Society & Politics	Psychology & Crime
Demystifying Research Methods	Applied Research Techniques
Fundamentals of Academic Writing	Professional Writing Skills
Professional Skills	Research Project

1.2. Rules

You are expected to refer to **Brightspace** regularly for notifications and monitor their university email account. This is essential to stay informed on important details regarding scheduling, assessments, deadlines, course content, etc.

Different courses in each module may have different rules. Consequently, you are strongly advised to carefully study the details for each course in this module manual. From 2022, **all projects follow the same rules** for students' activity levels reflection in grades and resit policy. They are described in detail within project manuals.

For further information, see the Programme and Examination Regulations (PER).

1.3. Study Load

Education unit	Form	Contact hours (45 min)	Self-tuition hours (60 min)	Credits	Examination	Weighing factor	Planning test (1 st Opp/re-sit)
Intro to Safety & Security	Lecture	42	126	6 ECTS	Mid-term exam	50 %	Refer to the schedule for the date, time and location of the first and second opportunity
					End-term exam	50 %	
Governance & Policy	Lecture	42	126	6 ECTS	Mid-term exam	50 %	
					End-term exam	50 %	
Society & Politics	Lecture	42	126	6 ECTS	Mid-term exam	50 %	
					End-term exam	50 %	
Demystifying Research Methods	Lecture, Workshop	28	84	4 ECTS	Cumulative Exam	100 %	
Fundamentals of Academic Writing	Lecture, Workshop	21	63	3 ECTS	Exam	100 %	
Professional Skills	Lecture, Workshop	35	105	5 ECTS	Mid-term group assignment	25 %	
					Mid-term individual assignment	25 %	
					End-term group assignment	25	

2. SUBJECT MATTER COURSES

2.1. Intro to Safety & Security

Lecturers: Jonathan Michael Corr (J.M.Corr@hhs.nl)
Enrique Gomez Llata Cazares (E.G.GomezLlataCazares@hhs.nl)

Code: SSMS-1T1-24

2.1.1. Introduction

This foundation course offers an introduction to the SSMS programme and its professional field of practice. It discusses the substantive fields of action of the SSMS professional, the various interventionist options open to the SSMS practitioner, as well as the different stakeholder approaches that SSMS professionals can pursue to effectively manage risks and improve safety and security. A designated lecture details and highlights the specific structure, logic, and spirit of the SSMS programme at THUAS. This course includes guest lectures by recent SSMS graduates or external partners, offering students a realistic and vivid picture of their future careers in the SSMS profession.

2.1.2. Learning goals

- 1) The student can conceptualise the various domains of safety and security addressed in the SSMS program.
- 2) The student can explain the relevance and importance of various stakeholder management approaches to safety and security management in different international environments
- 3) The student can summarise the structure and main ideas of the SSMS programme and its multidisciplinary character.
- 4) The student can explain how selected elements related to risk management and resilience can be applied in the context of international safety and security.

2.1.3 Literature

Bieder, C. & Petterson Gould, K. (eds.) (2020). *The coupling of safety and security: Exploring interrelations in theory and practice*. Cham: Springer Nature.

(pdf. available online free of charge).

NB: Additional required literature may be given by individual lecturers throughout the course.

2.1.4. Examination

Examination Mid-Term and End-Term	
Type of examination	Mid-term exam: Remindo Written Exam
	End-term exam: Oral Assessment
Material for examination	All course literature and lecture slides
Type of product	N/A
Submission protocol	N/A
Criteria	Instructions provided in-class
Weighting	Mid-term exam: 50%
	End-term exam: 50%
Assessment procedure	N/A

Pass mark	Mid-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
	End-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
Deadlines and possibilities	Mid-term exam: 1 st Opportunity: November 2026 2 nd Opportunity: January 2027
	End-term exam: 1 st Opportunity: February 2027 2 nd Opportunity: April 2027

2.1.5. Programme

Session	Subject and contents (lessons)	Format	Preparation
1 9 sept	Introduction - The SSMS programme. 'Safety and security' as a field of study and professional practice.	Lecture (Corr & Gomez Llata)	
2 16 sept	Safety and security interventions	Lecture (Gomez Llata)	Bieder (2020) - chs. 1 & 2
3	Communication matters	Lecture (Corr)	
4	Stakeholders, actors & the impact of culture	Lecture (Gomez Llata)	Bieder (2020)- chs. 3 & 5
5	Managing safety and security	Lecture (Corr)	
6	Resilience in safety & security	Lecture (Corr)	Bieder (2020)- chs. 7 & 9
7	Tales from the field (alumnus)	Lecture (external guest speaker)	<i>Mandatory Attendance</i>
8	Recap & exam preparation	Lecture (Corr & Gomez Llata)	Bieder (2020) - ch. 10
Mid-Term Examination & POP Week			
9	Tales from the field	Lecture (external guest speaker)	<i>Mandatory Attendance</i>
10	Crime, safety & security	Lecture (Matczak)	<i>Mandatory Attendance</i>
11	Artificial intelligence in security risk	Lecture (Voss)	<i>Mandatory Attendance</i>
12	The human security approach	Lecture (de Ryck)	<i>Mandatory Attendance</i>
13	<i>TBD</i>	Lecture	
14	Industrial safety in action	Lecture (Ren)	<i>Mandatory Attendance</i>
15	Applied security risk management	Lecture (Ekici)	<i>Mandatory Attendance</i>

16	Recap and exam preparation	Lecture (Corr & Gomez Llata)	
End-Term Examination			

NB: At the time of publishing of this module manual, this programme was in a preliminary stage and therefore may be subject to change (also due to the availability of guest lecturers). You are expected to refer to Brightspace and MyTimetable for such changes on a regular basis.

2.1.6. Rules & Regulations

Class attendance is not mandatory, but strongly recommended in order for students to successfully complete the course. Guest lectures must be attended. Scheduled dates and deadlines for presentations, workshops, in-class assignments, tests, excursions etc. must be met without fail.

2.2. Governance & Policy

Lecturers: Dr. Ines Trigo de Sousa (I.M.R.deSousa@hhs.nl)

Dr. Enrique Gomez Llata (E.G.GomezLlataCazares@hhs.nl)

Dr. Marc-Oliver Del Grosso (M.O.DelGrosso@hhs.nl)

Code: SSMS-1T2-22

2.2.1. Introduction

Most safety and security management professionals spend a good deal of their time working in and dealing with bureaucracies: more or less permanent, hierarchically structured, goal-oriented organizations designed for getting centralized decisions - “policies”- carried out through lower-level personnel.

This introductory course highlights the functioning of public –governmental- bureaucracies such as fire departments, schools, ministries, armies, the police, intelligence agencies and municipalities. It discusses the various kinds of people that inhabit the bureaucratic world and the political context in which they must operate. In doing so, this course seeks to offer a realistic picture of what government agencies actually do and why they do it, taking into account differences in governance systems and bureaucracies across the world.

In the second part of the course, students will be familiarized with the issues and practice of policy and decision making in organizations. It can involve public and private organizations (governments and businesses), but also mixtures of public and private (e.g., hybrid and civil society organizations). Using analytically distinct phases in the process of policy making and based on scientific literature, this course provides insight into the challenges, problems and dilemmas that policy-makers face in their decision making and in the way they handle this in practice. At the end of the course the students will be familiar with a number of major obstacles and pathologies that hinder the ideal of a rational policy practice.

2.2.2. Learning goals

- 1) The student can identify the basic features of public organizations.
- 2) The student can explain the importance of organization to the functioning of bureaucracies.
- 3) The student can conceptualize different categories of bureaucratic employees, types of bureaucratic agencies and the major factors shaping their work in different cultural contexts.
- 4) The student can distinguish between distinguish public and private actors, but also between mixtures of public and private organizations in different international contexts in the process of policy making.
- 5) The student can distinguish the different phases of the policy making process.
- 6) The student can explain the challenges, problems and dilemmas that policymakers face in decision making in different international contexts.
- 7) The student can explain how a number of major obstacles and pathologies hinder the ideal of a rational policy making and design.

2.2.3. Literature

Buckwalter N.D., Balfour D.L. (2020) Democratic Legitimacy in Bureaucratic Structures: A Precarious Balance. In: Paanakker H., Masters A., Huberts L. (Eds). *Quality of Governance*. Palgrave Macmillan

[The book "Quality of Governance" is available for download from the HHS library. The text, "Democracy Legitimacy in Bureaucratic Structures: A Precarious Balance" corresponds to chapter 2 of this book.]

Leo Huberts, Muel Kaptein & Bart de Koning. (2022). Integrity Scandals of Politicians: A Political Integrity Index, *Public Integrity*, 24:3, pp. 329-341

To link to this article: <https://doi.org/10.1080/10999922.2021.1940778>

Levi-Faur, D. (2012). From "big government" to "big governance". The Oxford handbook of governance, 3-18. Retrieved from https://www.researchgate.net/publication/286958228_From_Big_Government_to_Big_Governance

McCormick, J., Hague, R., & Harrop, M. (2022). Comparative government and politics: An introduction (12th ed.). *Bloomsbury Academic*.

Reader/ Via WebEDU (for 2nd part of semester)

A **reader** has been prepared, containing all the relevant literature. The reader is available at the online WebEDU store (<https://www.webedu.nl/bestellen/edustore/>).

Allison, G. and P. Zelikow (1999), 'Introduction', in: G. Allison and P. Zelikow, *Essence of decision. Explaining the Cuban Missile Crisis*. New York [etc.]: Longman, 1-12.

House, E.R. (1974), The Politics of Evaluation in Higher Education. *The Journal of Higher Education*, 45(8), pp. 618-627.

Weiss, C.H. (1987), Where Politics and Evaluation Research Meet. In D.J. Palumbo (Ed.), *The Politics of Program Evaluation* (pp. 47-70). Newbury Park, CA: Sage.

Recommended literature:

Sørensen, E., & Torfing, J. (2018). Governance on a bumpy road from enfant terrible to mature paradigm. *Critical Policy Studies*, 12(3), 350-359.

2.2.4. Examination

Examination Mid-Term and End-Term	
Type of examination	Mid-term exam: Individual written exam
	End-term exam: Individual written exam
Material for examination	All course literature and lecture slides
Type of product	Mid-term exam: NA
	End-term exam: NA
Submission protocol	Mid-term exam: NA
	End-term exam: NA
Criteria	Mid-term exam: See (re-sit) exam and answer key
	End-term exam: See (re-sit) exam and answer key
Weighting	Mid-term exam: 50%
	End-term exam: 50%
Assessment procedure	Mid-term exam: See (resit) exam and answer key
	End-term exam: See (resit) exam and answer key
Pass mark	Mid-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
	End-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
	Mid-term exam:

Deadlines and possibilities	1 st Opportunity: November 2026 2 nd Opportunity: Refer to the schedule for the date, time and location of the first and second opportunity
	End-term exam: 1 st Opportunity: February 2027 2 nd Opportunity: Refer to the schedule for the date, time and location of the first and second opportunity

2.2.5. Programme

Session	Subject and contents (lessons)	Format	Preparation
1 11 Sept	Governance and Policy: An introduction	Lecture Dr. Gomez Llata	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapter 1
2	Executives and Bureaucracies	Lecture Dr. de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapters 8 & 10
3	Political participation and political parties	Lecture Dr. de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapters 13 & 15
4	Interest Groups and Public Policy	Lecture de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapters 16 & 17
5	The development of a paradigm: From Government to Governance	Lecture Dr. Gomez Llata	<u>Compulsory reading:</u> Levi-Faur, D. (2012), pp. 3-18. <u>Recommended reading:</u> Sørensen, & Torfing, (2018), pp. 350-359.
6	Democracy and bureaucracy: on the role of norms and values in building governance practices	Lecture Dr. Gomez Llata	<u>Compulsory reading:</u> The text, "Democracy Legitimacy in Bureaucratic Structures: A Precarious Balance" corresponds to chapter 2: In: Paanakker H., Masters A., Huberts L. (Eds). <i>Quality of Governance</i> . Palgrave Macmillan.
7	Public Governance: a case study	Lecture Dr. Gomez Llata	<u>Compulsory reading:</u> Leo Huberts, Muel Kaptein & Bart de Koning (2022) Integrity Scandals of Politicians: A Political Integrity Index, <i>Public Integrity</i> , 24:3, 329-341, To link to this article: https://doi.org/10.1080/10999922.2021.1940778
8	Recap and exam preparation	Lecture Dr. Gomez Llata & Dr. de Sousa	
Mid-Term Examination & POP Week			
9	Introduction to decision-making	Lecture Dr. Del Grosso	Alison, pp. 1-12
10	Agenda setting	Lecture Dr. Del Grosso	
11	Policy formulation	Lecture	

		Dr. Del Grosso	
12	Policy implementation 1	Lecture Dr. Del Grosso	
13	Policy implementation 2	Lecture Dr. Del Grosso	
14	Policy evaluation	Lecture Dr. Del Grosso	House, pp. 618-627; Weiss, pp. 47-70
15	Policy making in practice	Lecture Dr. Del Grosso	
16	Overview and exam preparation	Lecture Dr. Del Grosso	
End-Term Examination			

2.2.6. Rules & Regulations

Class attendance is not mandatory, but strongly recommended in order for students to successfully complete the course. Guest lectures must be attended. Scheduled dates and deadlines for presentations, workshops, in-class assignments, tests, excursions etc. must be met without fail.

2.3. Society & Politics

Lecturers: Dr. Menandro S. Abanes (M.S.Abanes@hhs.nl)

Dr. Ines Trigo de Sousa (I.M.R.deSousa@hhs.nl)

Code: SSMS-1T3-21

2.3.1. Introduction

The course is considered to be among the essential academic “parent disciplines” of safety and security studies. It combines sociology and political science. Sociology mainly deals with the way people live together and interact with each other in societies. Politics is, as defined by Laswell, about “who gets what, when and how”. Political institutions and politicians decide are also the ones who decide on rules that closely influence safety and security: from setting (safety and security) standards and enforcing compliance, fighting crime and terrorism, surveillance of their citizens to waging war. These processes differ significantly in different countries, often depending on regime type and the ideological and value orientation of the government majority.

In this course, we will first learn sociological perspectives which will locate our own experiences within the larger scale of society characterized by social structure and system. We will also be able to view familiar scenes in a new light, find new meanings in the old and new ways of doing things, and gain understanding and insight of the rapidly globalizing and, at the same time, increasingly diversifying world. We will look into the three main themes of sociology: identity, social order, and stratification. Each of these themes poses an issue with safety and security management in societies. In the end-term module, we will focus on the basics of political science by introducing different types of regimes (democratic, hybrid, authoritarian, totalitarian), their institutions and functioning, regime change, political ideologies, and various factors that influence how politics plays out, such as the concepts of states, nations, identity, social pressures or foreign influence. Relevant examples will be given from either current political events or famous illustrative historical cases.

At the end of the course, students will have attained a new and much broader perspective on current events and the socio-political challenges of the modern world. Practical examples and small activities to highlight certain concepts and how they relate with safety and security issues in our societies will be given and conducted.

2.3.2. Learning goals

- 1) The student identifies major classical and contemporary sociological perspectives, sociological concepts related to identity, social stratification and social order in different international contexts, and how they relate to issues of safety and security.
- 2) The student sociologically interprets his/her/their assessment of certain situations with safety and security issues in mind.
- 3) The student explains the basic tenets and concepts on which states and political systems of democratic and authoritarian regimes are based upon.
- 4) The student distinguishes between different ideologies and types of regimes that exist worldwide.
- 5) The student converts abstract concepts such as democratization, power or authority into concrete, real-world examples and vice versa.

2.3.3. Literature

Mid-term exam:

Macionis, J. J., & Plummer, K. (2012). *Sociology: A global introduction*. England: Pearson Education Ltd. (5th edition)

End-term exam:

McCormick, J., Hague, R., & Harrop, M. (2022). *Comparative government and politics: An introduction* (12th ed.). *Bloomsbury Academic*.

2.3.4. Examination

Examination Mid-Term and End-Term	
Type of examination	Mid-term exam: Individual written exam
	End-term exam: Individual written exam
Material for examination	All course literature and lecture slides
Type of product	Mid-term exam: NA
	End-term exam: NA
Submission protocol	Mid-term exam: NA
	End-term exam: NA
Criteria	Mid-term exam: See (re-sit) exam and answer key
	End-term exam: See (re-sit) exam and answer key
Weighting	Mid-term exam: 50%
	End-term exam: 50%
Assessment procedure	Mid-term exam: See (resit) exam and answer key
	End-term exam: See (resit) exam and answer key
Pass mark	Mid-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
	End-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
Deadlines and possibilities	Mid-term exam: 1st Opportunity: 13 November 2026 2nd Opportunity: Refer to the schedule for the date, time and location of the second opportunity
	End-term exam: 1st Opportunity: February 2027 2nd Opportunity: Refer to the schedule for the date, time and location of the first and second opportunity

3.2.5. Programme

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Session	Subject and contents (lessons)	Format	Preparation
1 9 sept	Introduction, sociological perspectives and methods	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 1 (pp.4-14; 21-25) Ch 2 (pp.33-52) Ch 4 (pp.106-116)
2 16 sept	Identity 1: Social construction of everyday life	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 7 Assignment: Application of sociological perspectives
3	Identity 2: Ethnicities and migration	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 11
4	Social order 1: Culture, social movements	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 5 (pp.144-158) Ch 16 (pp.563-567)
5	Social order 2: Control and deviance	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 17
6	Social stratification 1: groups, organizations, network society	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 6
7	Social stratification 2: social division, class	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 8
8	Risk society, cities, and spaces	Lecture Dr. Abanes	Ch 23 (pp.795-797) Ch 24 (p.830; pp.841-849; p.855)
Mid-Term Examination & POP Week			
9	Introduction. Politics, states and nations.	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapter 3
10	Political culture and political ideologies.	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapter 4
11	Democratic rule.	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapter 5
12	Democratic institutions: media & elections	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapters 12 & 14
13	Authoritarian rule	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapter 6
14	Hybrid regimes and the democratization process	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	TBD
15	Political Economy	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	McCormick, Hague & Harrop (2022), Chapter 18
16	Recap and preparation for exams.	Lecture Dr. Trigo de Sousa	
End-Term Exam			

3.2.6. Rules & Regulations

Class attendance is not mandatory, but strongly recommended in order for students to successfully complete the course. Guest lectures must be attended. Scheduled dates and deadlines for presentations, workshops, in-class assignments, tests, excursions etc. must be met without fail.

3. TRACK COURSES

3.1. Demystifying Research Methods

Lecturer: Jonas Carinhas (J.F.DaCostaCarinhas@hhs.nl)

Code: SSMS-1RM1-25

3.1.1. Introduction

Every research investigation needs to have a clear purpose, defining what the research will deal with, and in what ways. In this course, students will be introduced to Research Methods as a valuable analytical toolkit for applied research and its common application in the field of Safety and Security. Among other things, they will become familiar with basic principles and concepts of applied research, as well as their connections and applications. They will also learn to formulate their own applied research design, including the delineation of research problems, the development of adequate applied research objectives, central questions, sub-questions, and the identification of potential research limitations.

These skills are essential to feel comfortable not only in SSMS, but in any applied research environment. DRM is the first in a series of courses of the Research Methods track, which aims to teach the students the necessary analytical and research skills that they will need for writing their assignments, reports, and bachelor's theses, and for solving practical problems in their future jobs.

3.1.2. Learning goals

- 1) The student applies basic applied research concepts to different safety and security situations and contexts.
- 2) The student conducts basic preliminary research on a safety and security topic using the 6W problem analysis framework on various types of literature.
- 3) The student distinguishes the main concepts and variables of a safety and security study, as well as examines their connections.
- 4) The student evaluates different research questions, in terms of their type, clarity, focus, relevancy, feasibility, complexity, bias, and ethicality, within different safety and security contexts.
- 5) The student appraises the research design, including the research approach, research problem, objective, central question, and sub-questions of different safety and security studies.
- 6) The student appraises safety and security studies in terms of potential limitations, such as data availability or access, sample size or representativeness, generalisability of results, time or budget constraints, and other relevant limitations.
- 7) The student formulates their own applied research design, including a research problem, objective, central question, and two (2) sub-questions for a safety and security topic.

3.1.3. Literature

There is no required literature to be purchased. All readings and exercises will be provided on Brightspace.

3.1.4. Examination

Examination Mid-Term and End-Term	
Type of examination	Cumulative exam with multiple-choice questions and open questions (done in three testing moments throughout the semester), three quizzes.
Material for examination	All literature and materials uploaded on Brightspace, such as PowerPoint presentations, case studies, workshop exercises, and home assignments.
Type of product	Remindo exam, Brightspace quizzes
Submission protocol	Remindo exam, Brightspace quizzes
Criteria	The MCQ cumulative exam must be assessed with a grade of 5.5 or higher (1-10 scale) in order to pass the course. Must received a Pass for the three quizzes.
Weighting	MCQ cumulative exam = 100% of final grade (moment 1 = 20%, moment 2 = 50%, and moment 3 = 30%) Quizzes = Pass/Fail
Assessment procedure	See (resit) exam and answer key
Pass mark	Mid-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
	End-term exam: A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
	Quizzes: Pass three quizzes
Deadlines and possibilities	<u>Cumulative exam</u> Moment 1: November 2026 Moment 2: December 2026 Moment 3: February 2027 Resit: Refer to the schedule for the exact date, time and location of the first and second opportunity. <u>Quizzes</u> Moment 1: Week 4 Moment 2: Week 7 Moment 3: Week 14 Resit: Refer to the schedule for the exact date and time of the first and second opportunity.

3.1.5. Programme

Session	Subject and contents (lessons)	Format	Preparation
1	Intro to Research Methods (part 1) - Role of applied sciences in SSMS.	Lecture	Read course manual
2	Intro to Research Methods (part 2) - Group work: applying core concepts to short SSMS cases.	Workshop	Check Brightspace
3	Intro to Research Methods (part 3) - Quiz about core concepts. - Preparation for CT1.)	Quiz	Check Brightspace
4	Understanding the problem (part 1) - 6W problem analysis framework and sources. - Concepts, variables, and relationships.	Lecture	Check Brightspace
5	Understanding the problem (part 2) - Group work: applying the 6W framework.	Workshop	Check Brightspace
6	Understanding the problem (part 3) - Quiz about 6W problem analysis framework. - Preparation for CT2.	Quiz	Check Brightspace
7	Intro to Research Methods (part 2, resit) - Resit Quiz about core concepts. - Preparation for CT1.	Quiz	Check Brightspace
8	Intro to Research Methods (part 3, resit) - Quiz about core concepts. - Preparation for CT2.	Quiz	Check Brightspace
CT1 test			
9	Planning your investigation (part 1) - Building an applied research design (ARD) and identifying limitations.	Lecture	Check Brightspace
10	Planning your investigation (part 2) - Building an applied research design (ARD) and identifying limitations.	Workshop	Check Brightspace
11	Planning your investigation (part 3) - Quiz on building an ARD and identifying limitations. - Preparation for CT2.	Quiz	Check Brightspace
CT2 test			
12	Integrating the whole process - Evaluating research choices across a full case. - Advice for Research Problem next semester. - Recap and Q&A	Lecture	Check Brightspace
13	Planning your investigation (part 3, resit) - Quiz on building an ARD and identifying limitations. - Preparation for CT2.	Quiz	Check Brightspace
CT3 test			

3.1.6. Rules & Regulations

Attendance at lectures and workshops is not mandatory but highly recommended. The content covered in these sessions directly prepares you for the exams. All classes are conducted in-person on campus. Unless announced otherwise, livestreams or recordings will not be provided.

You are expected to refer to Brightspace regularly for updates about the course content, schedule, assessment details, or other announcements. It is your responsibility to stay informed.

All individual assignments and tasks must be completed without the assistance of unauthorised tools or other people. Using AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Gemini) for tasks that are meant to be completed individually is considered a breach of academic integrity. Keep in mind that you will not have access to these tools during exams, and that their output often fails to meet the required academic standards.

At THUAS, additional time, resources, and guidance are made available to students with disabilities. Upon consultation with your assigned Academic Advisor, accommodations can be made as needed to ensure that you can fully participate in the course and its assessments. Accommodations cannot be made unless this official process has been followed.

3.2. Fundamentals of Academic Writing

Lecturer: Senj Temple (S.E.Temple@hhs.nl)

Simone Hackett (S.E.Hackett@hhs.nl)

Code: SSMS-1S2-20

3.2.1. Introduction

The Academic Writing Course is designed to give students advanced tools in writing in English to aid them in their studies, research, and the workplace. The ability to write well in an academic and professional context is crucial to success in the SSMS field. Having a good oral proficiency in English does not guarantee being a good writer. The focus in this course will be on the fundamentals of academic and professional writing: how to structure paragraphs, how to create cohesion and coherence in a text, how to structure concise sentences, and how to produce a formal and professional style of writing. There will also be a focus on how to paraphrase. Attention will be given to punctuation, verb tense, and other aspects of grammar, but students will be expected to polish these areas in self-study with resources provided in a toolbox on Brightspace. Academic Writing is far more than just having good grammar or knowing where to place a comma.

3.2.2. Learning goals

- 1) The student can write academic text consisting of paragraphs with topic sentences and develop ideas using techniques of cohesion and coherence.
- 2) The student can produce academic sentences of suitable length, structure, and grammatical accuracy.
- 3) The student can produce text in the appropriate (formal) academic style of writing.
- 4) The student can identify the key points in a written text.
- 5) The student can paraphrase.

3.2.3. Literature

There is no required literature to be purchased. All readings and exercises will be provided on Brightspace by the lecturer.

3.2.4. Examination

Examination	
Type of examination	Written Exam (in Remindo)
Material for examination	The final exam will be similar to the writing tasks assigned throughout the course.
Type of product	NA
Submission protocol	NA
Criteria	See Assessment Forms in appendix 2
Weighting	100 %
Assessment procedure	See Assessment Forms in appendix 2
Pass mark	A grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)
Deadlines and possibilities	Exam: Practice Exam: 15 October 2026 Final exam (100%): 14 December 2026 Re-sit: Refer to the schedule for the date, time and location of the first and second opportunity

3.2.5. Programme

Session	Subject and contents (lessons)	Format	Preparation
1	What is a paragraph? What is a topic sentence?	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
2	6 tips to writing good paragraphs	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information Assignment: Task 1
3	10 characteristics of a more formal, academic writing style	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
4	5 tips to writing good sentences	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
5	Practice Exam in Remindo	Practice exam in computer room on campus	See Brightspace for specific information Assignment: Task 2
6	Techniques for combining sentences	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information Assignment: Task 3
7	How to paraphrase	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
8	Common mistakes + Review	Lecture	See Brightspace for specific information
Exam			

3.2.6. Rules & Regulations

Class attendance is not mandatory but strongly recommended for students to complete the course successfully.

Furthermore:

- 1) Several written tasks will be assigned during the course. Writing is a skill that needs to be practiced. Feedback will be given on your writing in these tasks which will help you identify what you are doing well and what needs to be polished. These tasks are the same as the one in the exam at the end of the course which is worth 100% of the course grade. These tasks should be uploaded on Brightspace in a Word document or pdf.
- 2) Peer Feedback is an essential element in this course. For several of the written tasks, students will be allocated a partner to both give and receive feedback according to the rubric on this task.
- 3) Students are responsible for polishing their grammar (verb tenses, relative clauses, conditionals, punctuation, parallel structure, comma splices) in the 'course information' on Brightspace. Little to no time will be devoted to this during the lectures due to time constraints.

3.3. Professional Skills

Lecturers: Gohar Baghdasaryan (co.) (G.Baghdasaryan@hhs.nl)

Andrew Pearce (A.G.H.Pearce@hhs.nl)

Boudewijn Wisse (B.M.Wisse@hhs.nl)

Jonathan Corr (j.m.corr@hhs.nl)

Siddik Ekici (S.Ekici@hhs.nl)

Code: SSMS-1S1-23

3.3.1. Introduction

The professional skills track is set up to recognize the fact that for the students to become effective in their future safety and security professions, they depend on more than the acquired analytical skills, academic knowledge, methodologies, and tools covered during the different SSMS theory courses. The SSMS graduate is expected to implement security solutions, conduct safety risk assessments, provide comprehensive advice about security risk management, and be effective in carrying out a range of other activities in his/her professional field. The SSMS graduate thus also depends on skills to engage effectively with business leaders, managers, and professionals at all levels in organizations' hierarchies. Furthermore, he/she is expected to operate with appropriate sensitivity to organizational contexts, manage complex projects, as well as present cases or write reports tailored to the needs of prospective policymakers, executives, operators, or analysts.

During the Course, students will be guided towards basic (yet important) professional skills required for the safety and security specialists. The theoretical part of the Course offers insights into some intricacies of communication, public speaking, personal branding, interpersonal conflict resolution, teamwork, leadership, consultancy skills and project management.

The more practice-oriented training revolves around delivering presentations, and general professional conduct such as punctuality and appropriate styles of communication.

The SSMS program covers a wide range of projects in which the students are required to apply those skills studied throughout their journey. As such, this course aims to help the student hit the ground running in the professional world. This applies both to the student's time during the program for applied projects, and internships amongst others and to pursuing a career after graduating from SSMS.

3.3.2. Learning goals

- 1) The student develops constructive collaboration with diverse stakeholders in various disciplines and cultural backgrounds.
- 2) The student adapts appropriate communication styles for diverse audiences, situations and objectives.
- 3) The student utilizes relevant digital tools (including AI) for generating various professional products and efficient communication of findings and innovative ideas.
- 4) The student builds the skills to lead safety/security projects and teams effectively while demonstrating self-regulation and professionalism.
- 5) The student converts activities and resources required for a specific objective into a plan.

3.2.3. Literature

There is no required literature to be purchased. The lecturers will provide most of the reading materials (web links to documents and articles) on the session slides or in Brightspace. See also the list of the required readings below:

- Amsel, T. T. (2019). An Urban Legend Called: “The 7/38/55 Ratio Rule.” *European Polygraph*, 13(2), 95–99. <https://doi.org/10.2478/ep-2019-0007>
- Giles, H. (2016). Communication Accommodation Theory. In *The International Encyclopedia of Communication Theory and Philosophy* (pp. 1–7). Wiley. <https://doi.org/10.1002/9781118766804.wbiect056>
- Intercultural Relations and Globalization. (2015). In *The SAGE Encyclopedia of Intercultural Competence*. SAGE Publications, Inc. <https://doi.org/10.4135/9781483346267.n169>
- Žemojtel-Piotrowska, M., & Piotrowski, J. (2023). Hofstede’s Cultural Dimensions Theory. In *Encyclopedia of Sexual Psychology and Behavior* (pp. 1–4). Springer International Publishing. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-08956-5_1124-1

Recommended (not mandatory)

- Avolio, B. J., & Bass, B. M. (1991). *The full range of leadership development: Basic principles and applications*. Thousand Oaks, CA: Sage Publications.
- Block, P. (2011). *Flawless consulting: A guide to getting your expertise used* (3rd ed.). Pfeiffer.
- Ohiagu, O. P. (2022). Revisiting McLuhan’s Thoughts on Medium as Message in the Digital Era. *Zaria Journal of Communication*, 7(1). https://www.researchgate.net/publication/360320372_Revisiting_McLuhan%27s_Thoughts_on_Medium_as_Message_in_the_Digital_Era
- Pease, B., & Pease, A. (2006). *The definitive book of body language: The hidden meaning behind people’s gestures and expressions*. Random House.

3.2.4. Examination

Examination	
Type of examination	2 Oral Exams (group presentations)
	Written exam (individual assignment)
Material for examination	Readings and additional exercises provided by the lecturers. All material is made available (referred to by web links) through the Brightspace.
Type of product	NA
Submission protocol	See the submission protocol in the appendices (Appendix A.2.3) and course manual
Criteria	See the Professional Skills assessment forms in the appendices and course manual
Weighting	Mid-term group presentation: 25%
	Mid-term individual assignment: 25%
	End-term group presentation: 50%
Assessment procedure	See the Professional Skills assessment forms in the appendices and course manual
Pass mark	A pass or grade of 5.5 or higher (scale 1-10)

Deadlines and possibilities	Mid-term group presentation 1 st opportunity: Semester 1, Week 10 (9-11 Nov, 2026) Re-sit opportunity: Semester 1, Week 17 (Jan, 2027)
	Mid-term individual assignment 1 st opportunity: Semester 1, Week 10 (Thu 12 Nov, before 23:59) Re-sit opportunity: Semester 1, Week 17 (Mon 11 Jan 2027 before 23:59)
	End-term group presentation 1 st opportunity: Semester 1, Week 20 (1-3 Feb, 2027) Re-sit opportunity: Semester 2, Week 4 (March, 2027)

3.2.5. Programme

Session	Subject and contents (lessons)	Format	Preparation
1	Kick-off Communication skills in safety & security	Lecture G. Baghdasaryan	Pease, B., & Pease, A. (2006) <i>See also the readings on the slides</i>
2	Communicating adverse information	Lecture G. Baghdasaryan	Giles, H. (2016) Ohiagu, O. P. (2022) <i>See also the readings on the slides</i>
3	Your communication style. Public speaking & presentation skills	Lecture G. Baghdasaryan	Amsel, T. T. (2019) <i>See also the readings on the slides</i>
4	Interpersonal conflict management	Lecture G. Baghdasaryan	<i>See the readings on the slides</i>
5	Intro to AI in safety & security	Lecture B. Wisse	<i>See the readings on the slides</i>
6	Branding a safety & security professional	Lecture G. Baghdasaryan	Žemojtel-Piotrowska, M., & Piotrowski, J. (2023) <i>See the readings on the slides</i>
7	Job applications & interviews	Guest lecture (TBD)	
Mid-Term Examination & POP Week			
8	Leadership skills	Lecture A. Pearce	Avolio, B. J., & Bass, B. M. (1991) <i>See also the readings on the slides</i>
9	Consultancy skills	Lecture J. Corr	Block, P. (2011) <i>See also the readings on the slides</i>
10	Project management skills	Lecture S. Ekici	<i>See the readings and the slides</i>
11	Project management skills	Lecture S. Ekici	<i>See the readings and the slides</i>
End-Term Examination & POP Week			

NB: At the time of publishing of this module manual, this programme was in a preliminary stage and therefore may be subject to change. You are expected to refer to Brightspace and MyTimetable for such changes on a regular basis.

3.2.6. Rules & Regulations

Class attendance is not mandatory but strongly recommended for students to successfully complete the course. Guest lectures must be attended. Scheduled dates and deadlines for presentations, submissions, etc. must be met without fail. The students/working groups that are late from the exam (presentation/online submission), fail the exam and will take the re-sit.

In the case of a noted lower contribution of an individual student, the tutor retains the right to decrease the individual grade due to:

- lack of participation in group activities (e.g., missing meetings, not communicating with the group and tutor, not being able to answer questions during the presentation)
- significantly low quality of contribution to the group work, decreasing overall outcomes (noticeable low quality of provided content, not improving it despite provided feedback)
- shortcomings in contributing to required work (late submissions, unprofessional conduct).

APPENDIX 1: COMPETENCIES AND LEARNING GOALS

A.1.1. Competencies

Year 1
1. COLLABORATION
Willingness and capability to cooperate with others on safety and security in a multidisciplinary and multicultural environment to support those involved in realising common goals. Safety and security specialists balance between different interests and agendas, convey accurate information, place trust in other parties, and encourage them to share their knowledge and skills. They can establish, build and maintain constructive relations with other professionals and agencies, and to share information and expertise with the aim of working together in a safe(r) environment.
2. ORGANISATION
Capability to assess, understand and act on the dynamics and effects of political and administrative forces in- and outside the organization.
3. COMMUNICATION
Capability to pass on information and ideas about risks, ideas, and solutions in a clear and focused manner to an audience consisting of specialists and/or non- specialists. Safety and security specialists can choose a way of communication that optimally fits different situations, partners, and objectives. They have a thorough command of various (oral, written, etc.) means of communication, and can make effective use of ICT tools.
4. ANALYTICAL AND INVESTIGATIVE CAPABILITIES
Capability to analyse, structure and, if necessary, restructure complex data distinguishing primary and secondary issues. Safety and security specialists are inquisitive and can think critically, coherently and logically, see connections and underlying mechanisms, and draw valid conclusions and evaluate consequences. Additionally, they are able to interpret data from management information systems in regard to potential risks. They can assess whether information is accurate and reliable.
5. DECISIVENESS
Capability to arrive at realistic, substantiated and actionable conclusions about possible alternatives based on available information.
6. RESULT ORIENTATION
Capability to formulate and set concrete objectives and priorities. Safety and security specialists can determine how much time completion of a task requires and which activities and resources are needed to achieve the overall objectives.
7. INNOVATIVENESS
Capability to approach security issues from different angles, with new, original ideas and solutions, and to break established thinking patterns.
8. LEADERSHIP
Capability to lead and direct projects, workgroups and teams related to safety and security. Additionally, safety and security specialists apply self-regulation when dealing with other professionals. This way they can lead dialogues and discussions on the goal to be accomplished and facilitate various parties and actors to contribute to their realization. They know how to create internal commitment to the safety and security culture in an organization.
9. REFLECTIVENESS
Safety and security specialists are self-critical and capable of positioning their role in relation to societal interest. They can look back in a structured manner and reflect on their own professional conduct and learn from the experiences made. They can assess societal impact of safety and security problems as well as solutions. Safety and security specialists can balance different values such as freedom, equality, innovation and continuity.

A.1.2. Learning goals

Learning goals	Course	Competencies
The student can conceptualise the various domains of safety and security addressed in the SSMS program.	Intro to Safety & Security	1,2,4,7
The student can explain the relevance and importance of various stakeholder management approaches to safety and security management in different international environments.	Intro to Safety & Security	1,4,7
The student can summarise the structure and main ideas of the SSMS programme and its multidisciplinary character.	Intro to Safety & Security	1,7
The student can explain how selected elements related to risk management and resilience can be applied in the context of international safety and security.	Intro to Safety & Security	4,7
The student can identify the basic features of public organizations.	Governance & Policy	2,4
The student can explain the importance of organization to the functioning of bureaucracies.	Governance & Policy	1,2,4,7
The student can conceptualize different categories of bureaucratic employees, types of bureaucratic agencies and the major factors shaping their work in different cultural contexts.	Governance & Policy	1,2,4,7
The student can distinguish between distinguish public and private actors, but also between mixtures of public and private organizations in different international contexts in the process of policy making.	Governance & Policy	1,2,4,7
The student is able to distinguish the distinct phases in the process of policy making.	Governance & Policy	2,4,7
The student can explain the challenges, problems and dilemmas that policymakers face in decision making in different international contexts.	Governance & Policy	2,4,7
The student can explain how a number of major obstacles and pathologies hinder the ideal of a rational policy making and design.	Governance & Policy	4,7
The student can identify major classical and contemporary sociological perspectives, sociological concepts related to identity, social stratification, and social order in different international contexts, and how they relate to issues of safety and security.	Society & Politics	2,4,7
The student can sociologically interpret his or her assessment of certain situations with safety and security issues in mind.	Society & Politics	2,4,7
The student can define key terms and milestones in the international history of political theory and comparative politics.	Society & Politics	4,7

The student can explain the basic tenets and concepts on which state institutions, democratic or authoritarian regimes based upon.	Society & Politics	2,4,7
The student can distinguish between different ideologies and types of regimes that exist around the globe.	Society & Politics	2,7
The student can convert abstract concepts such as democratization, state failure, or power and authority into concrete, real-world examples and vice versa.	Society & Politics	1,2,4,7
The student applies basic applied research concepts to different safety and security situations and contexts.	Demystifying Research Methods	4, 5
The student conducts basic preliminary research on a safety and security topic using the 6W problem analysis framework on various types of literature.	Demystifying Research Methods	4, 5
The student distinguishes the main concepts and variables of a safety and security study, as well as examines their connections.	Demystifying Research Methods	4, 5
The student evaluates different research questions, in terms of their type, clarity, focus, relevancy, feasibility, complexity, bias, and ethicality, within different safety and security contexts.	Demystifying Research Methods	4, 5, 6
The student appraises the research design, including the research approach, research problem, objective, central question, and sub-questions of different safety and security studies.	Demystifying Research Methods	4, 5, 6
The student appraises safety and security studies in terms of potential limitations, such as data availability or access, sample size or representativeness, generalisability of results, time or budget constraints, and other relevant limitations.	Demystifying Research Methods	4, 5, 6
The student formulates their own applied research design, including a research problem, objective, central question, and two (2) sub-questions for a safety and security topic.	Demystifying Research Methods	4, 5, 6
The student can write academic text consisting of paragraphs with topic sentences and develop ideas using techniques of cohesion and coherence.	Fundamentals of Academic Writing	3
The student can produce academic sentences of suitable length, structure, and grammatical accuracy.	Fundamentals of Academic Writing	3

The student can produce text in the appropriate (formal) academic style of writing.	Fundamentals of Academic Writing	3
The student can identify the key points in a written text.	Fundamentals of Academic Writing	3
The student can paraphrase.	Fundamentals of Academic Writing	3
The student develops constructive collaboration with diverse stakeholders in various disciplines and cultural backgrounds.	Professional Skills	1
The student adapts appropriate communication styles for diverse audience, situations and objectives.	Professional Skills	3
The student converts activities and resources required for a specific objective into a plan.	Professional Skills	6
The student utilizes relevant digital tools (including AI) for generating various professional products and efficient communication of findings and innovative ideas.	Professional Skills	7
The student builds the skills to lead safety/security projects and teams effectively while demonstrating self-regulation and professionalism.	Professional Skills	8

APPENDIX 2: ASSESSMENT FORMS

A.2.1. Assessment Form Submission Protocol

ASSESSMENT FORM SUBMISSION PROTOCOL
Assessment criteria
<u>Deadline</u> - Product was handed in on time via Brightspace.
<u>Size</u> - Reporting is in accordance with the minimum and maximum number of A4, as required in the assessment form.
<u>Editing</u> - A single font and character size is used (preferably Times New Roman, 12).
<u>Title page</u> - Document has a title page with title and date - Course, class and, if applicable, project group number - First names, family names, student numbers, student e-mails. - Name teacher/evaluator
<u>Layout</u> - Chapters and paragraphs have numbers and headings; pages are numbered (correctly).
<u>Acknowledgement of sources</u> - Acknowledgement of sources in APA style.
<u>Linguistic skills</u> - Spelling and grammar are correct - Text structure and argumentation

A.2.2. Assessment rubric for Fundamentals of Academic Writing

	1 = unsatisfactory	2 = needs improvement	3 = competent	4 = excellent	Points earned
Content	The summary does not adequately represent the gist or the main points of the original text.	The summary shows a general understanding of the original article but omits one or more main points and/or includes unimportant information.	The summary demonstrates thorough understanding of the original text and accurately identifies the important points with only a few inconsistencies.	The summary shows a comprehensive understanding of the original text, accurately identifying and presenting all the important points.	
Paraphrasing	The text contains many sentences or word chunks copied from the original article and/or paraphrasing attempts are incomprehensible. Minimal professional jargon is used.	The text shows some attempt to paraphrase but includes chunks from the original. Paraphrasing is sometimes unclear. Some professional jargon is used.	The text is well paraphrased with minor exceptions. Professional jargon is consistently used.	The text is significantly different from the original, accurately conveying the same ideas. Professional jargon is appropriately used throughout.	
Paragraphs (coherence and cohesion)	Text lacks clear paragraph structure, topic sentences, and logical flow. Reader struggles to understand the text.	Paragraphs are not always logically organised and may lack topic sentences. The text generally flows but has some errors making it difficult to follow.	Paragraphs are visible and logical, with topic sentences. Information is well-organised and flows well, with minor issues.	Paragraphs are clearly defined and logical, with effective topic sentences. Information is well-organised and flows seamlessly.	
Sentence structure, grammatical range and accuracy	Limited range of sentence structures with many grammatical, punctuation, and spelling errors, making the text difficult to read.	Mix of simple and complex sentences with noticeable grammatical, punctuation, and spelling errors.	Wide range of sentence structures with mostly error-free grammar, punctuation, and spelling. Minor errors present.	Wide range of sentence structures with full flexibility and accuracy. No or almost no grammatical, punctuation, or spelling errors.	
Style	Writing style is informal and not academic. Much informal language is used.	Writing style is generally formal/academic but has several informal exceptions.	Writing style is mostly formal/academic with minor informal language exceptions.	Writing style is consistently formal/academic with no use of informal language.	
TOTAL					/20

To pass, you must have no score of 1 on the rubric.

Points	Grade
20	10
19	9.5
18	9
17	8.5
16	8
15	7.5
14	7
13	6.5
12	6
11	5.5
10	5.1
9	4.7
8	4.3
7	3.9
6	3.5
5	3

A.2.3. Submission Protocol: PS mid-term assignment (resume & cover letter)

Submission criteria
Deadline • First Opportunity: Semester 1, Week 10 • Resit Opportunity: Semester 1, Week 15 Submission • Upload the vacancy description (full text in English, and NOT a web link), your resume and cover letter (also diplomas/certificates from relevant trainings if applicable) <u>all in English</u> and merged in <u>a single PDF file</u>. • Name the file as follows: student's name and job title (e.g. T. Smith_junior consultant). • Your file must be uploaded to the 'Submission Point' folder in Brightspace. Layout • Use matching templates for your resume and cover letter. • The resume must be no longer than A4 format paper. • The cover letter length is between 350-400 words. • Use visuals throughout the resume and cover letter where applicable (photo, images, icons, etc.). Linguistic skills • Spelling and grammar are correct. • Text structure and argumentation are clear and logical.

A.2.4. Professional Skills: Mid-term assignment (resume & cover letter) assessment form

Student (ID):	PS tutor:
Criteria	Judgement
Assessment form submission protocol	
Does the assignment fulfil the formal requirements as listed in the submission protocol? An unchecked box means that the submission has been rejected.	☐
Resume	
1.Relevance and Alignment with Job Requirements: The resume clearly demonstrates how the candidate's skills, experience, and qualifications align with the specific requirements of the job they are applying for. It includes tailored content that reflects the key competencies and responsibilities outlined in the job description.	☐
2.Clarity and Structure: The resume is well-organized, easy to read, and logically structured. It uses headings, bullet points, and concise language to effectively highlight the candidate's qualifications and achievements, ensuring that the most important information stands out.	☐
3.Quantifiable Achievements and Impact: The resume includes specific accomplishments that quantify the candidate's contributions, such as metrics, percentages, or numbers that demonstrate success and impact (e.g. language proficiency levels such as basic, fluent or A1, B2, etc.)	☐
4.Professional Presentation and Formatting: The overall presentation of the resume is clean, professional, and free from errors. This includes consistent font style and size, appropriate use of white space, templates, visuals, and attention to detail with spelling, grammar, and punctuation.	☐
5.Relevant Skills: The resume features a section that clearly lists relevant skills, including both technical and soft skills. It also incorporates industry-specific terms that apply in the field and align with the job description.	☐
Cover letter	
6.Customization and Relevance: The cover letter is tailored specifically to the job and organization the candidate is applying to. It clearly addresses the job requirements and demonstrates how the candidates' experience, skills, and qualifications make them a strong fit for the position. This includes mentioning the company's name and referencing specific aspects of the job description.	☐
7.Structure and Formatting: The cover letter is well-organized and easy to follow, with a clear introduction, body, and conclusion. It has proper paragraphing, spacing professional font, appropriate margins, and consistent alignment.	☐
8.Narrative: The opening is engaging and concise, immediately highlighting the candidate's interest in the role and the company. The body provides specific examples of relevant experience and skills. The conclusion summarizes the candidate's suitability, and expresses enthusiasm for the role position, and includes a call to action.	☐
9.Professional Tone and Language: The cover letter maintains a professional tone throughout, using clear and concise language free from jargon, errors, and informal expressions. It demonstrates the candidate's communication skills, showcasing their ability to convey information effectively and professionally.	☐
10.Evidence of Research and Alignment with Company Values: The cover letter reflects that the candidate has researched the company and understands its mission, values, and culture. It should draw connections between the candidate's	☐

background and the company's goals, showing how they can contribute meaningfully to the organization.	
Final mark (pass/fail) *	

**The passing mark consists of the fulfilment of at least 7 of all (10) criteria.*

A.2.5. Professional Skills: Mid-term assignment assessment form (group presentation)

Working group:	Lecturer (PS tutor):
Presentation topic:	Final (group) grade:

Criteria	
I. Content / Q&A	
1. Presentation reflects all requirements of the assignment.	☐
2. The weak and strong aspects of verbal and non-verbal communication are discussed thoroughly.	☐
3. Pertinent examples are provided to support conclusions/ideas with evidence.	☐
4. Presenters demonstrate full knowledge by answering questions with explanations and elaboration.	☐
II. Structure and organization of a presentation	
5. Presentation is well-structured; provides clear purpose and subject.	☐
6. Presentation time is spread evenly between the presenters.	☐
III. Delivery	
7. Presenters hold the attention of an entire audience with the use of direct eye contact, seldom looking at notes.	☐
8. Presenters speak with fluctuation in volume and inflection to maintain audience interest and emphasize key points.	☐
9. Presenters do not use verbal fillers.	☐
10. Presenters speak at an appropriate pace.	☐
11. Presenters are dressed professionally according to business attire principles.	☐
IV. Presentation Slides Layout / Design / Language	
12. All visuals are attractive (<i>size, quality, colour, shape, etc.</i>) and support the content of the presentation.	☐
13. Font formats (<i>e.g., type, colour, style, etc.</i>) have been carefully planned to enhance readability and highlight key points.	☐
14. Background enhances text or other graphics.	☐
15. Use of slide space is justified with proper allocation for text and visuals.	☐
16. Presentation has no misspellings or grammatical errors.	☐
V. Reflection on the project planning & teamwork	
17. The reflection to the project implementation and teamwork identifies shortcomings and focuses on future improvements.	☐
Final grade (Pass/Fail)*	

*The passing mark consists of the fulfilment of at least 9 of all (17) criteria and meets at least 1 criterion per section (I-V).

A.2.6. Professional Skills: End-term assignment assessment form (group presentation)

Working group:	Lecturer (PS tutor):
Presentation topic:	Final grade:

Criteria	Weight	Grade (1-10)
1. Content / Organization / Q&A	40%	
- Presentation is well-structured; provides a clear purpose and subject, pertinent examples/facts; supports conclusions/ideas with evidence. - The content reflects on all required elements of the assignment. - The students demonstrate full knowledge by answering questions with explanations and elaboration.		
2. Delivery	25%	
- Presenters hold the attention of an entire audience with the use of direct eye contact, seldom looking at notes. - Presenters speak with fluctuation in volume and inflection to maintain audience interest and emphasize key points. - Presenters do not use verbal fillers. - Presenters speak at an appropriate pace. - Performance time is spread evenly between the presenters. - Presenters are dressed professionally according to business attire principles.		
3. Presentation Slides Layout / Design / Language	20%	
- All visuals are consistent, attractive (e.g., size, colour, style, quality, shape, etc.), and support the content of the presentation. - Font formats (e.g., type, colour, style, etc.) have been carefully planned to enhance readability and content. - Slides' background enhances text or other graphics. - Use of slide space is justified with proper allocation for text and visuals - Presentation has no misspellings or grammatical errors.		
4. Project Management /Teamwork / Constructive Feedback	15%	
- The project is a group effort. The contribution of the group members is visible and clearly illustrated. - The reflection on project planning and teamwork is exceptionally professional and has a productive manner. It identifies current shortcomings and focuses on future improvements. - Potential risk factors to the project success are clearly identified. The potential options to overcome the issues are suggested.		
Total grade*	100%	

*The total grade consists of the sum of the weighted grades per criteria.

APPENDIX 3: SPECIAL CONDITIONS FOR SELECTED COURSES

A.3.1. SSMS Qualification for the Leiden University Master's Programme 'Crisis and Security Management'

The following elements within the existing SSMS curriculum have been earmarked as required units, given specific conditions, in order for any SSMS student to be guaranteed a spot on the CSM Master's programme upon successful graduation from SSMS.

This spot is only offered to the current Y-4 cohort of SSMS students. Since the number of candidates allowed into the programme is limited students will be selected based on several requirements which includes their overall performance in SSMS throughout the first three years. If you are selected, you will be directly contacted by SSMS. If you do not receive such a formal invitation, you are NOT eligible to join the Master's programme.

Students must furthermore obtain a **minimum GPA (average grade) of 7.5 for ALL the following courses per year combined:**

Year 2

- Safety Risk Management
- Geopolitics & National Security
- Conflict studies & Peacebuilding
- Culture, Policy & Management
- Quantitative & Qualitative Data Analysis

Year 3

- Managing Corporate Challenges
- Research Consultancy Project

NB: All the criteria listed above must be met by the end of Year 3 at the latest.

Students must also obtain a **minimum grade of 7.5 for EACH of the following elements:**

Year 4

- Written Thesis
- Thesis Defence

English language requirements: NONE

For further inquiry please contact the Leiden University admissions office at admissionCSM@fgga.leidenuniv.nl.

More information you can also find at: <https://www.universiteitleiden.nl/en/education/study-programmes/master/crisis-and-security-management>

A.3.2. Acceptance to the Year 3 Internship Programme

The following courses must be passed with an overall minimum GPA (average grade) of 7.5 to be accepted to the SSMS Year 3 internship programme:

Year 1

- 1) Governance & Policy
- 2) Business & Quality Management
- 3) Professional Skills 1
- 4) Professional Abilities 2
- 5) Professional Abilities 3 (Assessment)
- 6) Professional Abilities 4 (Assessment)

Year 2

- Culture, Policy & Management
- Safety Risk Management
- Project

A.3.3. Year 4 Study Advice

The results of the following research methods courses will be taken into account in the study advice procedure for Year 4. Moreover, students must have successfully completed ALL SSMS group projects as well as ALL components of the Year 3 elective space before entering Year 4.

For further information, please refer to the Year 4 Manual.

Year 2

- Project
- QQDA course

Year 3

- Research Consultancy Project

APPENDIX 4: CHANGES COMPARED TO LAST YEAR

Society & Politics end-term exam literature will at least partly change. There may be a last opportunity exam.

APPENDIX 5: ACADEMIC CALENDAR

2026-2027	from	until
Autumn Break	19-10-2026 (Monday)	23-10-2026 (Friday)
THiNK FeST	05-11-2026 (Thursday)	
Christmas Break	21-12-2026 (Monday)	01-01-2027 (Friday)
Spring Break	22-02-2027 (Monday)	26-02-2027 (Friday)
Easter Weekend	26-03-2027 (Friday)	29-03-2027 (Monday)
May Break	26-04-2027 (Monday)	30-04-2027 (Friday)
King's Day	27-04-2027 (Monday)	
Liberation Day	05-05-2027 (Wednesday)	
Ascension Day	06-05-2027 (Thursday)	07-05-2027 (Friday)
Pentecost	17-05-2027 (Monday)	
Summer Break	19-07-2027 (Monday)	27-08-2027 (Friday)

Applicable principles for annual planning and recess periods

- 1) An academic year consists of 42 education weeks.
- 2) The university of applied sciences divides an academic year into two semesters of 20 weeks (not counting weeks of recess and holidays), each consisting of two periods of 10 weeks, with an one-week extension after the second semester.
- 3) This one- week extension is intended for activities to complete the year: resits, certification, objections etc.
- 4) The minors are divided into blocks of 10 weeks each (not including recess and holiday weeks). Depending on the minor, the duration is either a block or a semester.
- 5) The academic year shall begin in the working week in which 1 September falls. If 1 September falls on a weekend, the academic year starts on the following Monday.
- 6) In the week preceding the first semester ("Week 0"), which is part of the summer recess, degree programmes may plan resits. Because this week falls in a recess period, no
- 7) regular educational activities are planned, except for introductions for first-year students.
- 8) For the autumn, spring, May and summer recesses and for the Christmas holidays, the advisory dates of OCW for the Haaglanden region will be followed.
- 9) The Hague University of Applied Sciences has a May recess of 1 week.
- 10) THiNK FeST falls on the Thursday of the 9th week of the first semester.
- 11) The buildings are closed on public holidays, on Good Friday, on the Friday after.
- 12) These principles lead to an extra week once every 5 to 6 years, for example in 2024.
- 13) No exams or lessons are taking place during Remembrance Day on the 4th of May at 20h00. The final time is on the 4th of May at 19h00.

Definitions

As the various holidays/recesses are not identical, we use the following definitions:

- **Holidays:** no activities required or compulsory for the study. This applies to periods when the buildings are closed.
- **Recess:** no scheduled education activities, but projects and resits/ examinations. This is the case during the autumn, spring, May- and summer break.

Explanation

The autumn, Christmas, spring, May- and summer recesses are in line with the holiday planning of the PO (primary) and VO (secondary) schools in the Haaglanden region and correspond to the OCW (Ministry of Education's) advisory dates for PO and VO region Midden.